Green Skills

The big idea

Green skills are the knowledge, abilities and attitudes needed to live and work in a way that protects the environment. In Class 10 the focus is **sustainable development** – progress that does not use up the planet.

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

Development that **meets the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs** (Brundtland Commission report, *Our Common Future*, 1987).

Why do we need it?

The world's population and consumption keep rising, but natural resources are limited. Problems we face:

- **Food** – loss of fertile soil, overuse of chemical fertilisers and pesticides.
- **Water** – falling groundwater, polluted rivers.
- **Energy** – dependence on coal and oil, which cause pollution and global warming.
- **Biodiversity loss** – deforestation and habitat destruction.
- **Waste** – plastic and e-waste piling up.

The three pillars

Sustainable development balances three things:

1. **Environment** – protect air, water, soil, forests and wildlife.

2. **Society** – health, education, equality and jobs for all.
3. **Economy** – growth and income, without destroying resources.

Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

In **2015**, the **United Nations** adopted **17 Sustainable Development Goals** to be achieved by **2030**. India is committed to them. Some of the goals:

No.	Goal
1	No poverty
2	Zero hunger
3	Good health and well-being
4	Quality education
5	Gender equality
6	Clean water and sanitation
7	Affordable and clean energy
13	Climate action
14	Life below water
15	Life on land
17	Partnerships for the goals

GET THE NUMBERS RIGHT

There are **17** SDGs, adopted in **2015**, with a target year of **2030**. Do not confuse them with the 8 Millennium Development Goals (2000–2015).

Our role in sustainable development

- **Reduce, Reuse, Recycle** (and Refuse single-use plastic).
- Save electricity: switch off lights and fans, use LED bulbs and star-rated appliances.
- Save water: fix leaks, harvest rainwater, reuse RO waste water.
- Use public transport, cycle or walk; car-pool.
- Plant trees and avoid wasting food and paper.
- Segregate waste into **wet (green bin)** and **dry (blue bin)**; dispose of e-waste at authorised centres.
- Prefer solar energy and other **renewable** sources.

Green jobs

Jobs that help protect or restore the environment are **green jobs** – solar panel technician, organic farmer, waste management worker, water conservation expert, eco-tourism guide.

EASY MARKS

When asked "how can students contribute", write specific actions (switching off fans, carrying a cloth bag) rather than vague lines like "save the earth".

Quick recap

- Sustainable development: meet present needs without harming future generations (Brundtland, 1987).
- Three pillars: environment, society, economy.
- 17 SDGs adopted by the UN in 2015, target 2030.
- Personal actions: 3Rs, saving water and energy, public transport, waste segregation.

Practice questions

1. How many Sustainable Development Goals were adopted by the United Nations?
   (a) 8 (b) 12 (c) 17 (d) 21
2. The target year for achieving the SDGs is
   (a) 2025 (b) 2030 (c) 2040 (d) 2050
3. The widely used definition of sustainable development comes from the
   (a) Brundtland Commission report (1987) (b) Paris Agreement (2015) (c) Kyoto Protocol (1997) (d) Stockholm Conference (1972)
4. SDG 6 is about
   (a) quality education (b) zero hunger (c) climate action (d) clean water and sanitation
5. Which action best supports sustainable development?
   (a) Using a private car for every short trip (b) Throwing e-waste with household garbage (c) Using LED bulbs and switching off unused appliances (d) Leaving taps running while brushing
6. Which of these is a green job?
   (a) Coal mine supervisor (b) Solar panel technician (c) Plastic bag manufacturer (d) Diesel generator dealer
7. Define sustainable development. Name its three pillars.
8. Suggest six ways in which you, as a student, can contribute to sustainable development.

Answers: 1. c 2. b 3. a 4. d 5. c 6. b 7. see notes 8. see notes